

[Clinical App Builder / GitHub Projects](#)

How to Turn a Clinical Need into a Small App

From irritation in practice to useful prototype

Series 2 of 3

Clear promise: A practical method for going from an observed pain point to a minimal working app concept.

Part of the Doctors Who Code lead magnet series for physician-builders.

Guide 2 of 3

How to Turn a Clinical Need into a Small App

From irritation in practice to useful prototype

Clear promise: A practical method for going from an observed pain point to a minimal working app concept.

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Start with the problem, not the technology

A weak project begins with excitement about AI, mobile development, or automation. A strong project begins with a repeated problem people already feel.

Ask what is breaking down, who is losing time, where errors or delays happen, and what would make the process easier without increasing cognitive load. The clearer the need, the easier the app becomes to design.

Define the user and the job to be done

Every useful clinical app has a primary user, even if other people touch it later. Define that user first. Then define the job the app helps them complete.

If you cannot say who the tool is for and what task it completes in one sentence, the concept is still too vague.

Decide what the app should not do

Scope is strategy. Good early products are narrow on purpose. Decide what stays out of version one so the real problem stays visible.

A simple app that removes one clear friction point is more valuable than a flashy system nobody trusts.

Choose the smallest viable version

- One user or one team.
- One recurring pain point.
- One reliable output.
- One accountable owner.
- One workflow you can test this month.

Closing thought

The most successful early physician-built tools are often unglamorous. They save time, reduce confusion, and fit naturally into real work. That matters more than spectacle.